



Majolica House

Location Vienna, Austria

Compared to its weightily Classical neighbors, Otto Wagner's Majolica House, completed in 1899, is almost shockingly modern. The building itself—two stories of shops with four stories of apartments above them—is restrained, its windows regular and rectangular. By contrast, its decoration has a refined yet vivid Art Nouveau opulence. Ceramic tiles of red flowers are used across the building, their design increasing in complexity as they climb toward the roof, reaching a boldly projecting cornice, with

a row of open-mouthed lions below it. The cornice itself is sheathed in elegantly attenuated acanthus leaves below striking red poppies. The building is framed on either side by cast-iron green balconies that jut from recessed vertical bays.

Town Hall, Copenhagen

Location Copenhagen, Denmark

Copenhagen's brick-built town hall, designed by Martin Nyrop and completed in 1905, was a potent vote of confidence in Denmark's future. However, architecturally, it

▲ THE MAIN ALTAR OF LIVERPOOL CATHEDRAL

looks backward to the civic buildings of the late Middle Ages—especially the Palazzo Pubblico in Siena (see p.335). The facade is animated at either end by impressive oriel windows (protruding bay windows). Over the principal entrance is a gilt figure of the 12th-century Bishop Absalom. The skyline is dominated by bold castellations. To one side is a similarly bold bell tower under a soaring spire, 348 ft (106 m) high. Throughout, the detailing is precise and lavish. The interior features a huge, glassed-in courtyard, with a handsome arcade in early Renaissance style running around three of its upper stories.

Liverpool Cathedral

Location Liverpool, England

Liverpool Cathedral, with its assured, bulky masses, is the last great building of the Gothic Revival in Britain and the largest cathedral in the UK. It was begun in 1903 and completed some 75 years later. It was the first building designed by its architect, Giles Gilbert Scott, but he proved an inspired choice. From the deeply recessed, soaring lancet windows over the main entrance to the great square tower that rears 280 ft (85 m) over the crossing, the building was conceived on the grandest of scales. The red sandstone exterior and lavish, shadowy interior complement each